THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

THURSDAY, NOVEMBER 12, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

Builders rally behind Jensen Huang as Nvidia's board weighs his future; Google ships AlphaGenome 2 and a model that only decides

Nvidia's board met Wednesday night to decide whether to remove its co-founder and CEO after reports of two extramarital affairs, one with a woman US intelligence reportedly suspects of being a Chinese spy. No decision had been announced by morning. Tim Sweeney called a firing "Apple firing Steve Jobs level of idiocy," Palmer Luckey wrote "China wants Jensen out, so I want him in," and David Heinemeier Hansson and Suhail Doshi argued for proportion and patience. Elon Musk, asked to hire Huang, replied "That would be an honor."

Google DeepMind released AlphaGenome 2, which predicts how DNA variants act in specific cell types, and Google launched a Decisions API whose model scores up to 1,000 questions in one pass instead of writing text. Musk put numbers on space solar and "actually usable" compute, said SpaceX would "happily" take back compute rented to Anthropic, and launched Grok Bot 1.0. Tesla's Robotaxi now runs around the clock in every city it serves.

I · NVIDIA

"Save Jensen": builders line up behind Huang as Nvidia's board meets

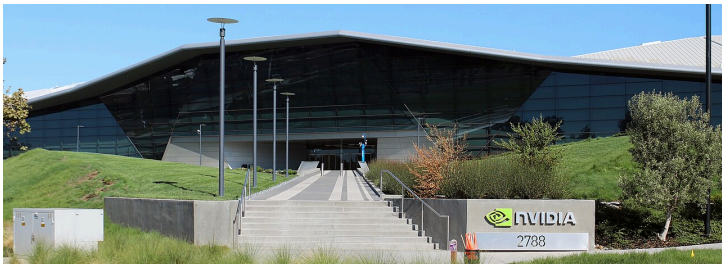
A Wall Street Journal report that the board was preparing to oust its founder sent the stock down and set off a rare chorus from tech leaders, most arguing the company would hurt itself and the country by acting in haste.

~8%	11	Nov. 17
Nvidia's after-hours drop after the Journal report, per TechCrunch	Directors who can remove the CEO by majority vote, with or without cause	Date Nvidia is due to report quarterly results

What happened Nvidia's board and the reports

The crisis began Sunday, after reports that US intelligence believes Alice Huang, a Megaspeed executive with whom the CEO had a relationship, helped arrange shipments of Nvidia chips to Chinese companies. Huang told employees in a memo that he had been unfaithful to his wife and took full responsibility, and the board said then it had confidence in him. On Wednesday the New York Times reported a second relationship, with an executive who reported to him, and the Wall Street Journal reported at 5:44pm EST that the board was "preparing to oust CEO Jensen Huang."

Reuters reported that the board met Wednesday to decide. Under Nvidia's bylaws a majority of its 11 directors can remove the CEO "with or without cause," and all but Huang are independent. Huang, 63, owns about 3.6% of the company and has no obvious successor. Semafor reported that some directors favor Chief Financial Officer Colette Kress as interim CEO, that Apple hardware chief Johny Srouji is among those considered, and that the board briefed the White House. Bernstein and Oppenheimer downgraded the stock.



Nvidia's headquarters on San Tomas Expressway in Santa Clara, California, photographed in August 2018.
PHOTO: COOLCAESAR · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Tim Sweeney @TimSweeneyEpic · CEO, Epic Games

Sweeney quoted the Journal's report within four hours:

> *"Save Jensen. This would be an Apple firing Steve Jobs level of idiocy from NVIDIA's board if they did that, and a grievous harm to the United States of America. The dude truly is the visionary driver of the future of tech from the gaming GPU era to CUDA to AI supercomputers."*
>
> TIM SWEENEY · @TIMSWEENEYEPIC · 9:40PM EST · POST

In a thread he traced Huang's record from "beating 3dfx" with the Riva TNT to programmable GPUs, CUDA and "now AI supercomputers," and compared HP and SGI, which "wasted it away with extraction, while NVIDIA consistently accepted lower margins in exchange for ubiquity." When Wall St Engine relayed the Semafor report on Kress, he replied at 12:32am EST: "Wow what a ridiculous shitshow it would be to replace one of the leading technology visionaries of the modern era with the company's money guy." He also questioned the Journal's anonymous sourcing.

Palmer Luckey @PalmerLuckey · founder, Anduril

Luckey's view, posted at 1:47am EST, drew more than 20,000 likes in a few hours:

> *"China wants Jensen out, so I want him in."*
>
> PALMER LUCKEY · @PALMERLUCKEY · 1:47AM EST · POST

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails and Omarchy

Heinemeier Hansson wrote at 3:52am EST: "NVIDIA would be wrong to fire Jensen. His marital indiscretions are between him, his wife, and a reprimand from the board. Have some proportionality."

Suhail Doshi @Suhail · CEO, Playground

Doshi proposed a cooling-off period:

> *"There should be a rule on boards that you do not make any moves on CEO for 2 weeks after a PR crisis (excluding criminal acts). Boards are often compelled to make decisions under public pressure but once that subsides there's a great clarity about what to do."*
>
> SUHAIL DOSHI · @SUHAIL · 12:19AM EST · POST

When a reply argued that directors act out of personal liability, citing a hypothetical Lockheed suspension, he answered: "1. D&O insurance 2. That's why you make it a governance rule for the board."

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, SpaceX and Tesla

Investor Gavin Baker argued the board should wait for its investigation "and/or have a shareholder vote after the investigation is complete," noting the 8% after-hours fall. Musk replied "Exactly" at 8:51pm EST, and agreed with Baker's follow-up that callers should press "people who can impact the decision." When Zero Hedge posted "Elon please hire Jensen," Musk answered at 8:22pm EST: "That would be an honor." It was his most-liked post of the day.

Clément Delangue @ClementDelangue · CEO, Hugging Face

One widely shared post claimed that "once Jensen falls Hugging Face shuts down" and urged people to download open models while they still could. Delangue replied at 11:05pm EST: "we're not going anywhere!"

II · COMPUTE & ENERGY

Musk puts numbers on space solar, "actually usable" compute and the Anthropic contract

In a run of replies, Musk argued that orbital power beats ground solar by a wide margin, said SpaceX brings big clusters online faster than rivals, and shrugged off a report that Anthropic will not renew its compute deal.

8 to 1	$120.5B	41
Musk's ratio: 100 GW in space is roughly 800 GW on Earth	Ceiling on Anthropic's SpaceX compute spending through 2029, per its filing	Gas turbines in SpaceX's Southaven, Mississippi, permit, upheld Nov. 10

Space solar @elonmusk · on power in orbit

A user marveled that 100 GW of solar capacity a year could, at full output, cover a fifth of US electricity use. Musk raised the target at 2:05pm EST:

> *"Actually, we're aiming for 1TW/year from Earth, rising to over 1PW/year from the Moon. That's why I say that if we achieve this outcome, SpaceX will obviously be worth more than Earth, because space is so staggeringly enormous!"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 2:05PM EST · POST

When another user noted that China installed 315 GW of solar in 2025, Musk replied at 3:22pm EST: "100GW in space is

roughly equal to 800GW on Earth. Moreover, solar on Earth must be paired with massive batteries to continue powering compute at night and supplemented with combustion or nuclear power during winter. These are not the same at all." A terawatt (TW) is 1,000 gigawatts (GW); a petawatt (PW) is 1,000 terawatts.

"Actually usable" compute @elonmusk · on data-center build-outs

Zero Hedge shared a Bernstein ranking of which developers' data-center pipelines are credible, led by Meta, Microsoft and Google. Musk replied at 2:01pm EST:

> *"SpaceX has a chance of going about half the GW next year of actually usable compute. "Actually usable" is an important metric. It takes us ~2 months working 24/7 to get a large compute cluster working reliably. I'd guess closer to 6 months for others."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 2:01PM EST · POST

The Anthropic contract @elonmusk · on renting compute

Notes posted Wednesday by an analyst said Anthropic told sell-side analysts it would not extend its SpaceX compute contract beyond mid-2027. Neither company confirmed that.

Anthropic's amended IPO filing, quoted by DailyMech, says it agreed to spend "up to $120.5 billion" through 2029, about $3.1 billion a month once all capacity is delivered, and that either side may cancel on 90 days' notice after non-cancelable periods ending in January and March 2027. Replying to a user who said the remark was likely an answer to a hypothetical, Musk wrote at 12:40pm EST: "We would be happy to take the compute back. No problem. But I think the opposite is going to happen."

A permit for Southaven Mississippi regulators

Mississippi's Environmental Quality Permit Board upheld the air permit for 41 gas turbines at the Southaven power plant of SpaceX's AI unit on Nov. 10, rejecting an appeal by opponents. A fan account put the plant at about 1.2 GW, to power compute including Colossus II. Musk replied: "Much appreciated, Mississippi."

QUICK HIT

Suhail Doshi said Playground "completely maxed out all our inference compute in 2w across customers" and offered a $20,000 referral award for post-training and inference engineers.

III · MODELS & AGENTS

Google ships AlphaGenome 2 and a model that decides instead of writing; Grok Bot leaves beta

Google DeepMind's DNA model now works cell type by cell type, Google's new API answers yes/no and multiple-choice questions at a fraction of a cent, and SpaceX's AI unit made its workplace agent a shared teammate.

100M+	1,000	$0.10
Single-cell profiles across 68 tissues used to train AlphaGenome 2	Questions Gemini Decision 1 can score in a single pass	Price per million input tokens; output tokens are free

AlphaGenome 2 @demishassabis · CEO, Google DeepMind · @sundarpichai · CEO, Google

> *"Super proud to announce AlphaGenome 2 - our new DNA sequence model! It predicts the impact of DNA variants in different specific cell types - unlocking crucial information for understanding complex diseases. Available for academic research via our API."*
>
> DEMIS HASSABIS · @DEMISHASSABIS · 12:12PM EST · POST

Pichai explained the idea at 11:23am EST: "Every cell in our body shares the same DNA blueprint, but different cell types (like heart muscle cells vs. immune cells) read that blueprint differently." DeepMind's announcement says the model reads a million letters of DNA, is conditioned on one tissue, cell type or state at a time, and finds nearly twice as many variants that change gene expression as its predecessor. Nature reported that it reproduced parts of a 2024 discovery about a gene driving inflammatory bowel disease "without lifting a pipette," and can make predictions for cell states it was not trained on. It is free for non-commercial research and in private preview for companies.

Gemini Decisions API @sundarpichai · CEO, Google

> *"Today we're launching the Gemini Decisions API, powered by our new Gemini Decision 1 model in @GoogleAIStudio. Instead of generating text token by token, it's built for closed-set choices scoring up to 1,000 questions across text, images, audio, video + PDFs in a single pass."*
>
> SUNDAR PICHAI · @SUNDARPICHAI · 1:15PM EST · POST

Pichai listed three decision types (yes/no, multiple choice with up to 255 options, and rubric scoring) and a price of "$0.10 / 1M input tokens with $0 billed for output tokens (~5x cheaper than Flash-Lite)." Google's blog pitches it for tool selection, policy checks and model routing, with answers and confidence

scores returned in 150–250 milliseconds. VentureBeat noted that OpenAI and Amazon already sell similar decision models.

Grok Bot 1.0 @elonmusk · @mntruell · CEO, Cursor

The Grok Bot team introduced version 1.0 as "AI teammates that work alongside your whole team," shared across Slack, Microsoft Teams and meetings. Musk quoted it at 1:28pm EST: "Hire Grok @Bot as a colleague and give it your hardest tasks!" The launch post lists three changes: shared Bots that learn from everyone they work with, Bots that spot unfinished work and offer to take it on, and faster, more reliable browser work. Team Bots need a Team or Enterprise plan. Michael Truell wrote "Bot 1.0 is out!" and Musk later quoted a creator who called it "the BEST AI agent orchestrator right now."

IV · MACHINES IN THE WORLD

Robotaxi goes around the clock, GRooT 2 runs a lab in real time, and a kei truck comes to Indiana

Tesla's ride service now runs 24 hours a day, Nvidia's robotics lead started posting uncut robot video, and the hardware stories ran from Starbase to a two-box AI cluster on a desk.

Tesla @elonmusk · CEO, Tesla

Tesla's Robotaxi account announced at 11:31pm EST: "Robotaxi now runs 24/7. Every city we're available in." Musk quoted it: "Robotaxi works 168 hours a week." TeslaNorth lists the cities as Austin, Dallas, Fort Worth, Houston, San Antonio, Miami, Orlando and Tampa.

Tesla Europe said its supervised self-driving is "now approved in Finland," with rollout soon, and Musk amplified it. He also announced at 12:11pm EST that "in order to work through more of the Cybertruck order backlog, production will be extended through the end of summer 2027," then added: "This is not the smartest move from a profit-maximizing standpoint btw, but there must be some room in this world for sentimentality or what's the point?" Asked why Tesla is building a school for robots, he replied: "Optimus Academy."

Jim Fan @DrJimFan · director of AI, Nvidia

A day after Nvidia opened its GR00T 2 robot model, Fan started a video series with no speed-up:

> *"Autonomous, uncut, 1x speed. This is GR00T 2 controlling real dexterous hands to perform a chemistry lab experiment (and clean up after itself) end to end. Episode 1 of a new series! I'll keep dropping real-time robot videos, with none of the "4x" or "8x" labels you usually see in the corner."*
>
> JIM FAN · @DRJIMFAN · 10:32AM EST · POST

Asked whether it was a 2-billion-parameter vision-language-action model, he answered: "It's a World Action Model (WAM)!"

Palmer Luckey @PalmerLuckey · founder, Anduril

Luckey cheered at 1:47pm EST: "Yes! Finally! The four-wheel-drive Toyota KEI-01 is going to be built in Gibson County, Indiana." Toyota's announcement introduces the ultra-compact utility truck under a revived Scion by Toyota brand, and local reports say the Princeton plant will start building it in the second half of 2027 with a $34 million investment and about 50 jobs. Luckey noted that "the Japanese version can do 65mph. This American one is currently electronically limited to 25mph, but NHTSA and DOT can change that." The National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) and the Department of Transportation (DOT) set those rules.

Lisa Su and Fei-Fei Li @LisaSu · chair and CEO, AMD · @drfeifei · co-founder, World Labs

Su wrote that she was at the Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL 2026) in Austin and "enjoyed the conversation with @drfeifei about the exciting advances in robotics, physical AI, and the opportunities ahead." Li shared the post.

Starship @elonmusk · CEO, SpaceX

SpaceX said Booster 22, "the first Super Heavy V3 booster planned to return to the launch site for catch," has moved to the pad at Starbase after catch testing that included "a suspended squeeze test at catch height." Musk shared it at 1:52pm EST.



An earlier Super Heavy booster descends to the tower's arms at Starbase, Texas, for the first booster catch on Oct. 13, 2024.
PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON · CC BY 2.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails and Omarchy

Heinemeier Hansson said at 10:14am EST that Omarchy 4.6, his Linux setup, "will let you share any model running on any Omarchy machine on your tailnet with another. Get a DGX Spark, then run inference from your XPS13 netbook." He then posted "We have frontier at home," running the open GLM-5.3 Flash model on a pair of Nvidia DGX Spark desktops reached over Tailscale from a MacBook Neo.

Tutors that teach thinking, a benchmark built on GTA, and how to judge code

Smaller posts from the watch list on AI in schools and games, and on the craft of building.

François Chollet @fchollet · creator of Keras, co-founder of the ARC Prize

Quoting Gakku's announcement that it raised $51 million for an AI learning coach built on conversation, Chollet wrote at 7:22pm EST:

> *"Conversational AI is going to transform education and deliver personalized tutoring at scale. But we have to build it right. Most current AI tools in education optimize for the wrong thing: getting the answer. But the point of homework is not the output, it's learning to think"*
>
> FRANÇOIS CHOLLET · @FCHOLLET · 7:22PM EST · POST

Suhail Doshi @Suhail · CEO, Playground

Doshi proposed GTABench: "what % of GTA can the model re-create? Start with GTA 1 and hill climb to GTA 6." Each task builds on a simple scaffold of the game, he explained, and on scoring he wrote: "Once 50% of humanity is arguing whether it's true or not, the benchmark is over."

Tim Sweeney @TimSweeneyEpic · CEO, Epic Games

Sweeney invited developers to the 2026 Epic AI MegaJam, whose partners include Anthropic's Claude, Google, OpenAI and SpaceX's AI unit. On game-store rules that require disclosing AI use, he asked: "So if you license an engine, the AI Police look the other way, but if you're a small developer who builds their own they put you in AI Disclosure Jail?" Palmer Luckey predicted that "anime conventions banning companies for AI are going to have to ban every major anime studio."

Uncle Bob Martin @unclebobmartin · author, Clean Code

Asked how he defines good code, Martin listed: "Low cyclomatic complexity. High branch coverage. High encapsulation. Dependency Rule conformance. ...and, I look at the structure."

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg · CEO, Vercel

Rauch posted a reminder at 2:34pm EST: "PSA: creating wonderful products still requires extraordinary amounts of human focus, effort, motivation, and love. And an attention span."

> **QUICK HIT**
>
> **Patrick Collison** welcomed Parafin, the small-business financing company, as Stripe said the acquisition is complete.

John Carmack and Tobi Lütke @ID_AA_Carmack · founder, Keen Technologies · @tobi · CEO, Shopify

To a user who said virtual reality is "dead at Meta" because it stopped funding big games, Carmack replied: "Meta squandering money on games that don't earn out is not a correlated indicator." Told that Shopify feels designed by people who have run a store, Lütke answered: "Because it has. Cavalry officers must know how to ride horses."

Takeaways

1. Nvidia's board holds the most consequential personnel decision in AI, days before the company's Nov. 17 results.
2. Tech leaders mostly argued for keeping Huang, citing his record from CUDA to AI supercomputers and the risks of acting under pressure.
3. Musk framed the compute race around power in space and clusters that are "actually usable," not just announced.
4. Google's two launches point the same way: specialized models (cell-level genomics, cheap closed-set decisions) next to the big generalists.
5. Autonomy is getting more routine: Robotaxi runs 24/7, and Nvidia now posts uncut real-time robot video.

On the beat

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Elon Musk, Marc Andreessen, Uncle Bob Martin, Demis Hassabis, John Carmack, Patrick Collison, Palmer Luckey, Vitalik Buterin, Tobi Lütke, David Heinemeier Hansson, François Chollet, Fei-Fei Li, Mustafa Suleyman, Paul Graham, Michael Truell, Clément Delangue, Jim Fan, Alexandr Wang, Lisa Su, Sundar Pichai, Kanjun Qiu, Guillermo Rauch, Michael Dell, Tim Sweeney, Kevin Weil, Suhail Doshi.

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Jensen Huang, Ashok Elluswamy, Andrej Karpathy, Sam Altman, Dario Amodei, Yann LeCun, Satya Nadella, Jeff Dean, Greg Brockman, Andrew Ng, Tom Brown, Mira Murati, Mark Zuckerberg, Noam Brown, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Joe Gebbia, Nat Friedman, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample, Mark Chen, Aaron Levie, Aidan Gomez, Albert Gu, Richard Sutton, Amin Vahdat, Koray Kavukcuoglu.

The watch list stands at 53.

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